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TAB 15



Board of Education Report

File #: Rep-333-23/24, Version: 1

Early Literacy School Block Grant (ELSBG) Annual Updates and End of Grant Report

June 18, 2024

Division of Instruction

Action Proposed:

Board ratification of the final Annual Plan Report for the six Los Angeles Unified schools participating in the Early Literacy School Block Grant (ELSBG). The California Department of Education (CDE) requires Board ratification of Annual Plan Reports. A total grant award of \$4,777,355 was received over the life of the grant which sunsets on June 30, 2024.

Background:

In 2017, the *Ella T. v. the State of California* lawsuit was filed on behalf of current and former students and teachers at three low-performing schools: La Salle Avenue Elementary School in Los Angeles Unified School District, Van Buren Elementary School in the Stockton Unified School District, and Children of Promise Preparatory Academy, a charter school in the Inglewood Unified School District. The suit alleged that the State violated students' civil rights by denying them a quality education and, specifically, a fundamental right to literacy. The case argued that state education officials knew of a reading and writing "crisis" in California public schools yet failed to develop a comprehensive plan or provide the funding necessary for early literacy.

On February 20, 2020, a settlement agreement was reached between the parties. State education officials have agreed to develop and implement the Early Literacy School Block Grant (ELSBG) as part of the agreement. The ELSBG was authorized by Senate Bill 98, Sections 113 and 114 (Statutes of 2020) of the Education Omnibus Trailer Bill.

Block Grant Amount

The State has agreed to allocate \$50 million over three years to eligible schools and no more than \$3 million in administrative costs for the California Department of Education (CDE) to administer grants, review and approve plans.

Grant Eligibility

The list of eligible schools consists of 75 schools, including charter schools. These schools had the highest percentage in the State of students scoring Level 1 on the grade 3 English Language Arts (ELA) Smarter Balanced Assessment (SBA), based on a two-year weighted average of the 2018 and 2019 ELA SBA results.

School	Award Amount	Board District	Region	Community of Schools
La Salle ES	\$563,140 (Annually: \$187,713)	1	South	HEET (C/D)
42nd ES	\$338,823 (Annually: \$112,941)	1	South	HEET (W)
YES Academy	\$943,848 (Annually: \$314,616)	1	South	HEET (W)

School	Award Amount	Board District	Region	Community of Schools
West Athens ES	\$943,848 (Annually: \$314,616)	1	South	HEET (W)
28th Street ES	\$943,848 (Annually: \$314,616)	2	East	Jefferson/South Central
Fries ES	\$943,848 (Annually: \$314,616)	7	South	Wilmington

The ELSB Grant is authorized for four years to provide funding to support early literacy development at identified schools through June 30, 2024. During the 2020-2021 planning year, each school completed a root cause analysis, conducted a needs assessment, and wrote a literacy action plan (LAP) that addresses the needs identified in the root cause analysis and needs assessment. In subsequent years, each school reviewed and revised their plans, and budgets were updated to reflect current schools needs in alignment with their goals. In this year, the final year of the grant, sustainability has been the focus of professional development and reporting.

The Los Angeles Unified Board of Education must be presented with annual plan updates. Grant funds only fund supplemental activities targeted for Kindergarten through Grade 3 inclusive and shall not supplant existing activities. There are four categories of grant expenditures allowed:

- Category 1: Access to High-Quality Literacy Teaching
- Category 2: Support for Literacy Learning
- Category 3: Pupil Supports
- Category 4: Family and Community Supports

The final end of year report outlines Year 3 of implementation of the grant. The Los Angeles Unified School District (LAUSD) extended robust support to participating schools through various initiatives. Ongoing professional development was provided to ensure effective implementation of a structured literacy approach, with workshops, templates, and feedback sessions aiding in the development of comprehensive plans. The district facilitated connections with vendors and offered continuous support for plan execution. Meetings for ELSBG school principals and team members fostered the sharing of best practices, while individualized budget update meetings and regular one-on-one check-ins with site principals ensured alignment with program goals and addressed challenges.

The support implemented through the ELSBG program significantly impacted literacy goals at participating school sites. The professional development and strategic initiatives led to noticeable improvements in DIBELS scores, indicating enhanced student proficiency in early literacy skills. Despite facing hiring challenges that hindered the seamless execution of plans, schools adapted by leveraging available resources and maintaining a strong commitment from teachers and administrators. This collective effort underscores the positive impact of the ELSBG program and highlights the importance of ongoing collaboration and investment in literacy initiatives to sustain and exceed literacy goals.

To ascertain the detailed activities for each participating school site, please see the Annual Plan Report attachment.

Expected Outcomes:

Board ratification of final annual plan report.

Board Options and Consequences:

Failure to ratify the final annual report could result in withholding of the reimbursement payment for Year 3 (final year).

Policy Implications:

This ELSB Grant supports the Board resolutions, Creating a Birth to Eight Roadmap for Success in Los Angeles and Realizing the Promise for All: Close the Gap by 2023. It also supports the Primary Promise initiative and the District's Local Control Accountability Plan (LCAP) early literacy goals.

Budget Impact:

None. There is no match requirement for this grant.

Student Impact:

Approval of the grant will support increased attendance, academic achievement and services for students at participating ELSBG schools.

Equity Impact:

Component	Score	Rationale
Recognition	4	All 6 participating schools (28 th Street ES, 42 nd Street ES, Fries ES, La Salle ES, West Athens ES and YES Academy ES) are in historically underserved communities with high percentages of traditionally underserved student groups such as English Learners, African American Students, Foster Youth Students with Disabilities, etc.
Resource Prioritization	4	Schools will use ELSBG funds to teach systematic, explicit foundational skills instruction in both whole group and small group settings using data to target the specific needs of students who represent student groups such as English Learners, Standard English Learners, African American students, Foster Youth, Students with Disabilities, etc.
Results	4	Implementation of literacy action plan strategies will increase DIBELS benchmark and progress monitoring data at participating schools.
TOTAL	12	

Issues and Analysis:

None.

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Attachments:

Attachment A - Early Literacy Support Block Grant Annual Report Implementation Year 3: 2023-2024

Informatives:

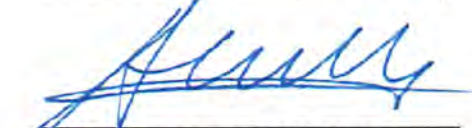
Not Applicable

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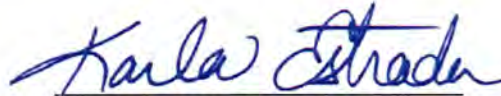
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RESPECTFULLY SUBMITTED,


ALBERTO M. CARVALHO
Superintendent

APPROVED & PRESENTED BY:

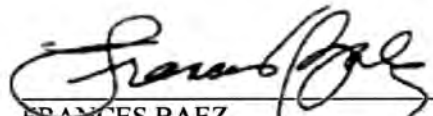

KARLA V. ESTRADA
Deputy Superintendent of Instruction

REVIEWED BY:


DEVORA NAVERA REED
General Counsel

☒ Approved as to form.

APPROVED & PRESENTED BY:


FRANCES BAEZ
Chief Academic Officer
Division of Instruction

REVIEWED BY:


NORBERTO DELGADILLO
Deputy Chief Business Officer, Finance

☒ Approved as to budget impact statement.

**Early Literacy Support Block Grant Annual Report
Implementation Year 3: 2023-24**

Local Educational Agency Name: Los Angeles Unified School District (LAUSD)

Program Lead: Jessica Niessen.

Email/Phone: jessica.niessen@lausd.net

Fiscal Lead: Julie Ly

Email/Phone: julie.ly@lausd.net

Eligible Participating School(s):

1. 28th Street ES.	6. YES Academy
2. 42nd Street ES	
3. Fries ES	
4. La Salle Ave ES	
5. West Athens ES	

Supporting Agency or Agencies: (i.e. Early Literacy Support Block Grant Expert Lead in Literacy, local county office of education, etc.): Early Literacy Support Block Grant Expert Lead in Literacy, Sacramento County Office of Education.

Background: Based on the root cause analysis and needs assessment conducted during the Planning Year (2020–21), Early Literacy Support Block (ELSB) Grant participating local educational agencies (LEAs) developed three-year literacy action plans that include goals and actions to improve literacy instruction at each eligible school. The literacy action plans identify metrics to measure progress toward the goals and planned expenditures, which fund supplemental activities targeted for kindergarten and grades one to three, inclusive.

Directions: For Implementation Year 3 (2023-24), the LEA Program Lead shall complete the template below and submit this form to ELSBGrant@cde.ca.gov by **July 31, 2024**.

**Early Literacy Support Block Grant Annual Report
Implementation Year 3: 2023-24**

Section I: Annual ELSB Report Requirements

Requirement: By checking the boxes below, I am certifying the LEA and schools have submitted this annual report on achievement towards the actions and goals described, and an assessment of progress made on the metrics identified in the literacy action plan to:

✓ The school site council at each eligible school

List the school names and dates the of the school site council meetings where the annual ELSB report was provided:

28th Street Elementary School Site Council (SSC) Meeting: May 16, 2024

42nd Street Elementary SSC Meeting: May 17, 2024

Fries Avenue STEAM Academy SSC Meeting: May 7, 2024

La Salle Avenue SDL Elementary SSC Meeting: May 21, 2024

West Athens Elementary SSC Meeting: May 24, 2024

YES Academy SSC Meeting: May 1, 2024

✓ The governing board or body of the LEA

Provide the date of the governing board meeting: June 18, 2024

✓ Publicly posted on the LEA's website, which may be found at the following URL:

<https://www.lausd.org/Page/17822>

**Early Literacy Support Block Grant Annual Report
Implementation Year 3: 2023-24**

Section II: How ELSB Funds Were Spent in Year Three

Directions: Please use the check boxes to note which of the following categories the LEA expended ELSB grant funds on and list which school sites used funds for those purposes:

✓ **Category 1.** Access to high-quality literacy teaching, including which of the following:

- ✓ Hiring of literacy coaches or instructional aides to provide support to struggling pupils, including, among others, bilingual reading specialists to support English learner programs.

Please enter relevant school sites: 28th Street, 42nd Street, Fries Avenue STEAM Academy, West Athens

- ✓ Development of strategies to provide culturally responsive curriculum and instruction.

Please enter relevant school sites: 42nd Street

- ✓ Evidence-based professional development for teachers, instructional aides, and school leaders regarding literacy instruction and literacy achievement and the use of data to help identify and support struggling pupils.

Please enter relevant school sites: 28th Street, 42nd Street , Fries Avenue STEAM Academy, La Salle Ave, West Athens

- ✓ Professional development for teachers and school leaders regarding implementation of the curriculum framework for English language arts adopted by the State Board of Education (SBE) pursuant to Section 60207 of the Education Code and the use of data to support effective instruction.

Please enter relevant school sites: 28th Street, 42nd Street

✓ **Category 2:** Support for literacy learning, including which of the following:

- ✓ Purchase of literacy curriculum resources and instructional materials aligned with the English language arts content standards and the curriculum framework for English language arts adopted by the SBE, but only if the literacy action plan also includes professional development for staff on effective use of these materials.

Please enter relevant school sites: 28th Street, 42nd Street, Fries Avenue STEAM Academy, La Salle Ave

- ☐ Purchase of diagnostic assessment instruments to help assess pupil needs and progress and training for school staff regarding the use of those assessment instruments.

Please enter relevant school sites: N/A

✓ **Category 3.** Pupil supports, including which of the following:

- ✓ Expanded learning programs, such as before- and after-school programs or summer school, to improve pupils' access to literacy instruction.

**Early Literacy Support Block Grant Annual Report
Implementation Year 3: 2023-24**

Please enter relevant school sites: 28th Street

- ☐ Extended school day to enable implementation of breakfast in the classroom or library models to support expanded literacy instruction.

Please enter relevant school sites: N/A

- ☐ Strategies to improve school climate, pupil connectedness, and attendance and to reduce exclusionary discipline practices, including in-school suspensions, that may limit a pupil's time in school.

Please enter relevant school sites: N/A.

- ✓ Strategies to implement research-based social-emotional learning approaches, including restorative justice.

Please enter relevant school sites: 42nd Street .

- ✓ Expanded access to the school library.

Please enter relevant school sites: 28th Street

- ✓ **Category 4.** Family and community supports, including which of the following:

- ☐ Development of trauma-informed practices and supports for pupils and families.

Please enter relevant school sites:

- ☐ Provision of mental health resources to support pupil learning.

Please enter relevant school sites: N/A

- ✓ Strategies to implement multi-tiered systems of support and the response to intervention approach.

Please enter relevant school sites: 28th Street.

- ✓ Development of literacy training and education for parents to help develop a supportive literacy environment in the home.

Please enter relevant school sites: 28th Street, 42nd Street, Fries Avenue STEAM Academy , La Salle Ave, West Athens

- ✓ Strategies to improve parent and community engagement and to improve communication with parents regarding how to address pupils' literacy needs.

Please enter relevant school sites: 28th Street , 42nd Street , La Salle Ave, West Athens

Early Literacy Support Block Grant Annual Report Implementation Year 3: 2023-24

Section III: LEA Support for Eligible Participating School Sites

Directions: LEAs that are not eligible participating school sites should complete this section.

1. What supports did the LEA provide to eligible participating school sites in Year 3 of implementation?

In Year 3 of implementation, the Los Angeles Unified School District extended support to eligible participating school sites in various ways:

- **Ongoing Professional Development Support:** Los Angeles Unified School District provided continuous professional development opportunities to support the implementation of a structured literacy approach.
- **Plan Writing Support:** Recognizing the importance of well-crafted plans in achieving program goals, the District offered guidance and assistance to school teams in developing comprehensive and effective plans. This support included workshops, templates, and feedback sessions to ensure that plans were aligned with the objectives of the program.
- **Provide Vendor Contacts and Support for Plan Implementation:** To facilitate the execution of the plans, the District supplied school teams with relevant vendor contacts and ongoing support. This involved connecting schools with educational resources, materials, and/or services necessary for implementing their plans successfully.
- **Meetings for ELSBG School Principals and Team Members:** The District organized meetings where principals and team members from ELSBG schools could come together to share experiences, best practices, and insights. These meetings included opportunities for school visits and observations of small group instruction, allowing participants to learn from each other's experiences firsthand.
- **Individual Budget Update Meetings:** Understanding the importance of financial planning and management, the District arranged individualized sessions to review and update school budgets. These meetings provided school leaders with the necessary support and guidance to allocate resources effectively in alignment with their plans and goals.
- **Regular One-on-One Check-ins with Site Principals:** Recognizing the value of personalized support, the District conducted regular check-in sessions with site principals. These sessions, conducted both virtually and in person, provided opportunities for principals to discuss progress, challenges, and any additional support needed to ensure the success of the program at their respective sites.

2. How have the supports impacted the goals noted in the school sites' Literacy Action Plan(s)?

The implementation of supports through the ELSBG program has played a pivotal role in shaping the trajectory of literacy development goals outlined in the school sites' Literacy Action Plans. One prominent measure of success has been the discernible improvement in DIBELS scores across participating schools. These scores serve as tangible evidence of enhanced proficiency in critical early literacy skills among students, reflecting the efficacy of the implemented supports. Through targeted interventions and strategic initiatives facilitated by the ELSBG program, students have shown measurable progress, signaling a positive impact on literacy outcomes.

Early Literacy Support Block Grant Annual Report Implementation Year 3: 2023-24

The journey towards achieving these goals has not been without its challenges. One notable obstacle has been the hiring challenges faced by the District, which have posed significant hurdles to the seamless execution of the literacy action plans. Difficulty in recruiting qualified personnel to support literacy instruction has impeded the delivery of essential services and interventions outlined in the action plans. Despite these challenges, schools have persevered, leveraging available resources and adapting strategies to mitigate the impact of staffing limitations on their literacy initiatives.

Amidst these challenges, the unwavering support from teachers and administrators has been instrumental in driving progress and maintaining momentum towards achieving literacy goals. Their endorsement of the progress made thus far underscores the effectiveness of the support provided through the ELSBG program. It reflects a collective acknowledgment of the positive impact of these initiatives on student learning outcomes and underscores the importance of continued collaboration and investment in literacy initiatives. Moving forward, sustaining this collaborative effort and addressing ongoing challenges will be crucial in ensuring continued progress towards achieving and exceeding the literacy goals outlined in the school sites' action plans.

3. In what ways will the LEA continue to support and sustain the work begun through the ELSB grant?

The Los Angeles Unified School District is committed to maintaining and bolstering the progress initiated through the ELSB grant program by implementing several strategic measures:

- **Continued Professional Development:** LAUSD will prioritize ongoing professional development opportunities for educators to enhance their instructional practices in literacy instruction. This will include workshops, seminars, and coaching sessions focused on evidence-based strategies for improving early literacy skills.
- **Resource Allocation:** LAUSD will allocate resources to sustain the acquisition of literacy curriculum resources and instructional materials aligned with state standards. This ensures that educators have access to the necessary tools to deliver high-quality literacy instruction and support student learning effectively.
- **Data-Informed Decision Making:** LAUSD will continue to emphasize the use of data to inform instructional practices and decision-making processes. By analyzing student performance data and progress metrics, educators can identify areas of improvement, tailor interventions to meet specific needs, and monitor the effectiveness of literacy initiatives over time.
- **Community Engagement:** LAUSD recognizes the importance of fostering strong partnerships with parents, families, and community stakeholders to support literacy development beyond the classroom. By engaging families in literacy activities, providing resources for at-home literacy support, and facilitating community events, the LAUSD has a comprehensive support network to reinforce literacy skills both in and out of school.
- **Sustainability Planning:** Finally, LAUSD will ensure the long-term viability of the literacy initiatives launched through the ELSB grant program. This includes strategies for securing continued funding, integrating successful practices into district-wide policies and procedures, and fostering a culture of continuous improvement in literacy instruction across all schools within LAUSD.

By implementing these measures, LAUSD is poised to sustain and build upon the work initiated through the ELSB grant program, ultimately fostering a culture of literacy excellence and equipping students with the essential skills they need to succeed academically and beyond.

**Early Literacy Support Block Grant Annual Report
Implementation Year 3: 2023-24**

4. What has the LEA learned as a result of the ELSB grant work that can be applied to current and future support of all school sites?

As a result of the Early Literacy Support Block Grant (ELSBG) work, LAUSD has gained valuable insights that can inform its support of all school sites, both now and in the future. One significant lesson learned is the critical importance of prioritizing Early Literacy Foundational Skills instruction. LAUSD has recognized the foundational role these skills play in laying the groundwork for future academic success. This understanding underscores the necessity of dedicating resources and attention to early literacy development efforts across all school sites.

Furthermore, the ELSBG grant work highlighted the effectiveness of utilizing a structured literacy approach in literacy instruction. By emphasizing systematic and explicit instruction in phonemic awareness, phonics, fluency, vocabulary, and comprehension—the core components of structured literacy—LAUSD observed improved outcomes in student literacy attainment. This approach ensures that all students receive comprehensive and scaffolded instruction tailored to their individual needs, setting them on a trajectory for continued growth and proficiency in reading and writing.

In addition, the integration of the science of reading principles into instructional practices emerged. By aligning instructional strategies with evidence-based research on how students learn to read, LAUSD witnessed enhanced student engagement and achievement in literacy. This emphasizes the importance of grounding literacy instruction in scientifically validated methods that promote effective learning and comprehension.

The grant work underscored the value of employing evidence-based instructional practices in literacy instruction. By prioritizing strategies and interventions supported by research and empirical evidence, greater consistency and efficacy in literacy outcomes across participating school sites was observed. This emphasizes the need for ongoing professional development and training to equip educators with the knowledge and skills necessary to implement evidence-based practices effectively.

By applying these lessons learned from the ELSBG grant work, LAUSD is positioned to strengthen its support of all school sites, ensuring that early literacy instruction is prioritized, structured literacy approaches are utilized, the science of reading is integrated into instructional practices, and evidence-based instructional strategies are consistently employed. This holistic approach to literacy support will empower all students to develop the foundational skills they need to succeed academically and beyond.

Early Literacy Support Block Grant Annual Report Implementation Year 3: 2023-24

Section IV: Statement of Goals, Implementation Year Three Progress, and Course Corrections

Directions: For each eligible participating school, please respond to the six questions. Please copy and paste the questions for LEAs with more than three school sites.

Eligible Participating School #1: 28th Street Elementary School

1. What are the “big picture” goals stated in the Literacy Action Plan? These can be located in Section 2: Literacy Action Plan Components.
 - Goal 1: Provide consistent and explicit instruction in foundational skills (K-3).
 - Goal 2: Provide consistent oral language development and explicit vocabulary instruction for our EL and EO students.
 - Goal 3: Provide explicit and systematic instruction in phonics, phonemic awareness, phonics, fluency, vocabulary, and comprehension.

2. What are the actions the LEA and school site have taken to progress toward those goals in Year 3 of the grant?
 - Implement PDSA Cycles of Improvement sessions in standards/ task alignment.
 - Multi-lingual and Mainstream Academic Language Coach (MMALC) has been supporting teachers in grades TK-3 with discussion strategies, academic discourse, instructional planning and co-teaching of ELD lessons has been the focus.
 - Instructional coach, MMALC Coach, TSP Coordinator have been supporting teachers in grades TK-3 during grade level planning, i-Ready data analysis and setting up structures for small group instruction.
 - Teachers in grades TK-3 levels have been meeting consistently during the morning planning sessions (PDSA Cycles) to progress monitor, and plan for ELA small group instruction.
 - Analysis of student work and planning using UBD.
 - Teachers have access to PD in foundational skills during Banked Time Tuesdays and through District/ ELSB sponsored PD's (OG, UFLI, LETRS, 95%, Heggerty).
 - Instructional walks and data chats by Instructional Team of (TK-3) classrooms/teachers. Feedback and support are provided in the following: setting up small group instruction structures, analysis of data to form instructional groups, differentiation of activities, foundational skills lessons (planning & co-teaching), peer observations and debrief.

3. What are the metrics the LEA and school site are using to measure progress on growth (student data) and/or actions (implementation)?

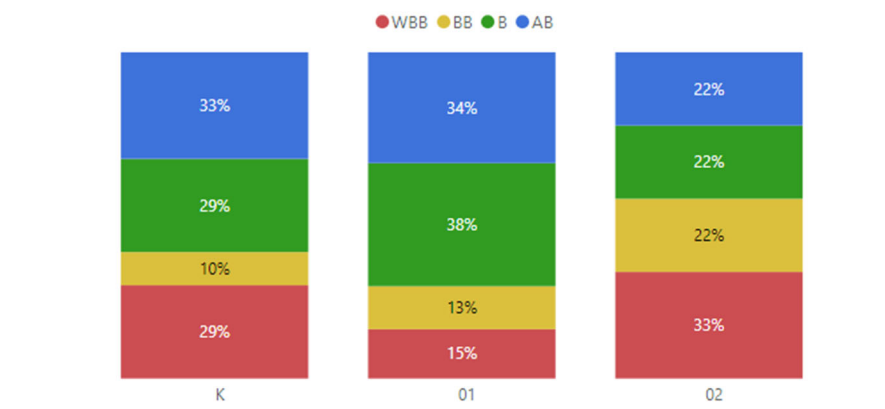
Students in TK-2 are using DIBELS to measure student growth. Grade 3 students are using i-Ready and ICA ELA assessments. Focus students are being progress monitored every 2-4 weeks. Interventionist and Instructional Coach are monitoring data and supporting teachers with data analysis and implications for instruction.

Include Year 3 quantitative results for kindergarten through grade three. In the table below, record the local literacy assessment used and the percentage of students scoring in the proficient (at or above standard) range in each of these grade levels.

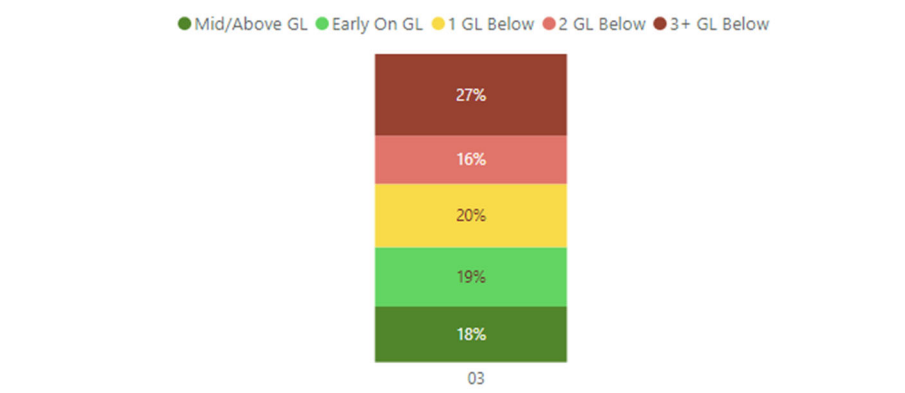
Early Literacy Support Block Grant Annual Report Implementation Year 3: 2023-24

Grade Level	Local Literacy Assessment	Current % of Students At or Above Standard
Kindergarten	EOY DIBELS	62%
First Grade	EOY DIBELS	72%
Second Grade	EOY DIBELS	44%
Third Grade	EOY i-Ready	37%

ELA DIBELS Composite Level (Gr K-2)



ELA Overall Relative Grade Level Placement



*Source: Interim Assessment Dashboard, June 10, 2024

4. Please provide an analysis of the metrics and specifically if the metrics are demonstrating progress towards goals. Compare baseline student data to current student data.

BOY/EOY Data Comparison

- K students in Benchmark and Above increased from 40% at BOY to 62% at EOY
- 1st grade students in Benchmark and Above increased from 51% BOY 72% EOY
- 2nd grade students in Benchmark and Above decreased from 49% BOY to 44% EOY
- 3rd grade students in Benchmark and Above increased from 20% at BOY to 37% EOY

Early Literacy Support Block Grant Annual Report Implementation Year 3: 2023-24

Schoolwide Focus Domains:

- Vocabulary and Academic Discourse
- Over-all Reading Comprehension
- Phonics

5. What has been the most notable change as a result of the site's ELSB grant work?

- The ELSB grant has provided 28th St. with the resources and professional development opportunities that have allowed us to implement the following all of which we attribute to our growth in ELA :
 - Small group instruction in every classroom in grades TK-3
 - Strong instruction in foundational skills (TK-1)
 - Differentiation during small group instruction
 - Teachers participate in PDSA cycles with the purpose of building their capacity in Language Arts and foundational skills
 - Focused grade level planning time
- Opportunities for teachers in grades TK-3 to attend PD on foundational skills outside of school site.
- Coaches and interventionist providing support and feedback to teachers in TK-3 with foundational skills instruction, progress monitoring and strategies for students not meeting grade level standards in ELA.
- Multiple opportunities for students to receive targeted intervention in ELA beyond the instructional day.
- Providing workshops to parents in early literacy skills and foundational skills.

6. In what ways will the site continue to support and sustain the work begun through the ELSB grant program?

- Our focus now needs to move away from intervention to strengthening Tier 1 instruction. Coaches and interventionists need to empower classroom teachers with strategies and help them create positive learning environments to provide a strong Tier 1 foundation. We have moved away from the pull-out model of intervention and transitioned to a push-in model. Interventionists have been supporting teachers setting up small group structures, co-planning of differentiated lessons, co-teaching and providing strategies for students not meeting grade level standards in ELA.
- Support parent education in early literacy skills and foundational skills.
- Continue PDSA cycles, data chats, and data analysis.

Eligible Participating School #2: 42nd Street Elementary

1. What are the “big picture” goals stated in the Literacy Action Plan?

- Goal 1: Teachers' capacity building in the quality of instructional delivery
- Goal 2: Provide explicit, systematic foundational reading skills instruction.

Early Literacy Support Block Grant Annual Report Implementation Year 3: 2023-24

2. What are the actions the LEA and school site have taken to progress toward those goals in Year 3 of the grant?

The school has implemented the following actions to support progress toward the goals of the ELSBG:

- Professional Development
- Grade Level Articulation & Planning
- Lesson Study
- Peer Observations
- After-school Intervention
- Targeted Small Group Instruction

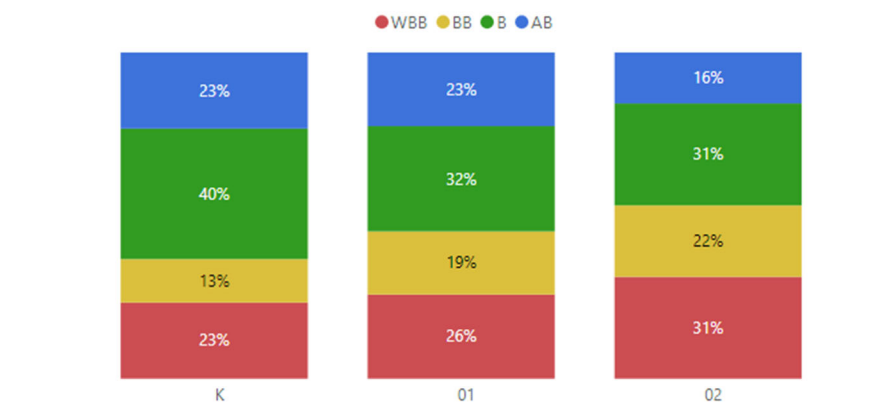
3. What are the metrics the LEA and school site are using to measure progress on growth (student data) and/or actions (implementation)?

- DIBELS (Bi-weekly Progress Monitoring)
- i-Ready

Include Year 3 quantitative results for kindergarten through grade three. In the table below, record the local literacy assessment used and the percentage of students scoring in the proficient (at or above standard) range in each of these grade levels.

Grade Level	Local Literacy Assessment	Current % of Students At or Above Standard
Kindergarten	EOY DIBELS	63%
First Grade	EOY DIBELS	55%
Second Grade	EOY DIBELS	47%
Third Grade	EOY i-Ready	39%

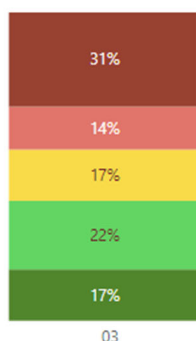
ELA DIBELS Composite Level (Gr K-2)



Early Literacy Support Block Grant Annual Report Implementation Year 3: 2023-24

ELA Overall Relative Grade Level Placement

● Mid/Above GL ● Early On GL ● 1 GL Below ● 2 GL Below ● 3+ GL Below



*Source: Interim Assessment Dashboard, June 10, 2024

4. Please provide an analysis of the metrics and specifically if the metrics are demonstrating progress towards goals. Compare baseline student data to current student data.

BOY/EOY Data Comparison

- K students in Benchmark and Above increased from 36% at BOY to 63% at EOY
 - 1st grade students in Benchmark and Above increased from 21% BOY 55% EOY
 - 2nd grade students in Benchmark and Above increased from 43% BOY to 47% EOY
 - 3rd grade students in Benchmark and Above increased from 3% at BOY to 39% EOY
5. What has been the most notable change as a result of the site's ELSB grant work?
 - The number of students scoring Benchmark increased by 8% in Kinder and 21% in 1st grade, (Comparison is from 2023 -24 BOY to 2023-24 MOY)
 - The number of students scoring WBB decreased in K-2 students from BOY to MOY (K decreased by 15%, 1st Grade decreased by 30%, and 2nd Grade decreased by 16%)
 - Consistent Bi-Weekly Progress Monitoring
 6. In what ways will the site continue to support and sustain the work begun through the ELSB grant program?
 - Provide each teacher with an Instructional Aide to support targeted small group instruction.
 - ILT will provide professional development on early literacy.

Eligible Participating School #3: Fries Avenue Elementary

1. What are the "big picture" goals stated in the Literacy Action Plan? These can be located in Section 2: Literacy Action Plan Components.
 - Goal 1: Provide explicit, systematic, phonemic awareness instruction
 - Goal 2: Provide explicit, systematic phonics instruction
 - Goal 3: Provide explicit, systematic vocabulary instruction
 - Goal 4: Provide explicit, systematic reading comprehension instruction

Submitted: 06/11/24, Revision #1

Early Literacy Support Block Grant Annual Report Implementation Year 3: 2023-24

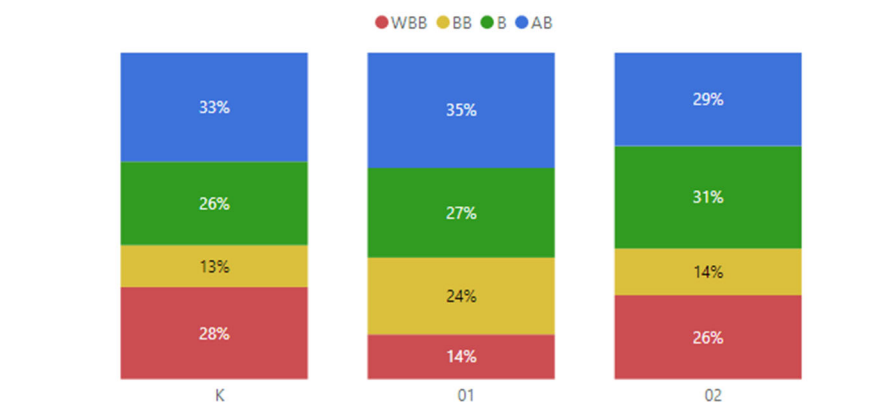
2. What are the actions the LEA and school site have taken to progress toward those goals in Year 3 of the grant?
- Professional Development
 - Coaching and Lesson Study
 - Grade Level Planning
 - PDSA Cycle for Early Literacy
 - Reading Academies in Grades K to 3 (Targeted Small Group Instruction)
3. What are the metrics the LEA and school site are using to measure progress on growth (student data) and/or actions (implementation)?

We are using DIBELS for K-2nd grade and i-Ready ELA for 3rd grade.

Include Year 3 quantitative results for kindergarten through grade three. In the table below, record the local literacy assessment used and the percentage of students scoring in the proficient (at or above standard) range in each of these grade levels.

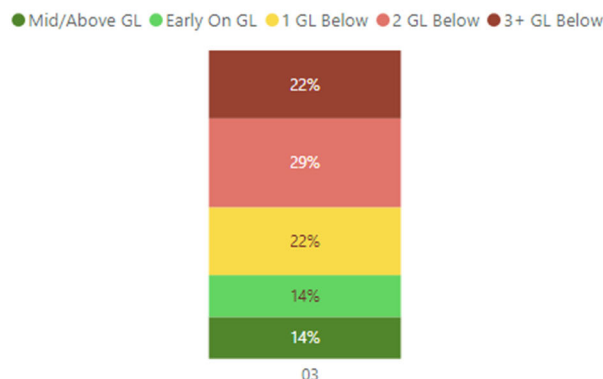
Grade Level	Local Literacy Assessment	Current % of Students At or Above Standard
Kindergarten	EOY DIBELS	59%
First Grade	EOY DIBELS	62%
Second Grade	EOY DIBELS	60%
Third Grade	EOY i-Ready	28%

ELA DIBELS Composite Level (Gr K-2)



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ELA Overall Relative Grade Level Placement



*Source: Interim Assessment Dashboard, June 10, 2024

4. Please provide an analysis of the metrics and specifically if the metrics are demonstrating progress towards goals. Compare baseline student data to current student data.

BOY/EOY Data Comparison

- K students in Benchmark and Above increased from 29% at BOY to 59% at EOY
- 1st grade students in Benchmark and Above increased from 22% BOY to 62% EOY
- 2nd grade students in Benchmark and Above increased from 52% BOY to 60% EOY
- 3rd grade students in Benchmark and Above increased from 8% at BOY to 28% EOY

5. What has been the most notable change as a result of the site's ELSB grant work?

The most notable change is that we have implemented Reading Academies in Grades Kindergarten through 3rd. We have a PDSA cycle for our Early Literacy. Teachers are progress monitoring students every 3 weeks, and they are meeting to plan targeted lessons. Teachers are using The Science of Reading to teach early literacy. My K-3rd grade teachers have been provided professional development in UFLI, Heggerty, LETRS, CORE, and OERA. When I visit classrooms I see teachers using the strategies learned.

6. In what ways will the site continue to support and sustain the work begun through the ELSB grant program?

We will continue to implement Literacy Academies for students in Kindergarten to 3rd Grade. We will continue with the PDSA Cycle for our early literacy academies.

Eligible Participating School #4: La Salle Elementary

1. What are the "big picture" goals stated in the Literacy Action Plan? These can be located in Section 2: Literacy Action Plan Components.
 - Goal 1: Provide explicit, phonemic awareness instruction.
 - Goal 2: Provide explicit, word recognition instruction.

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2. What are the actions the LEA and school site have taken to progress toward those goals in Year 3 of the grant?

We have taken the learning of explicit phonemic awareness and word recognition instruction and applied it to our newly adopted program, Core Knowledge Language Arts (CKLA), to implement it with fidelity. We are also developing teacher efficacy in the Science of Reading with advanced phonics instruction such as multisyllabic vowel recognition, morphology, and vocabulary.

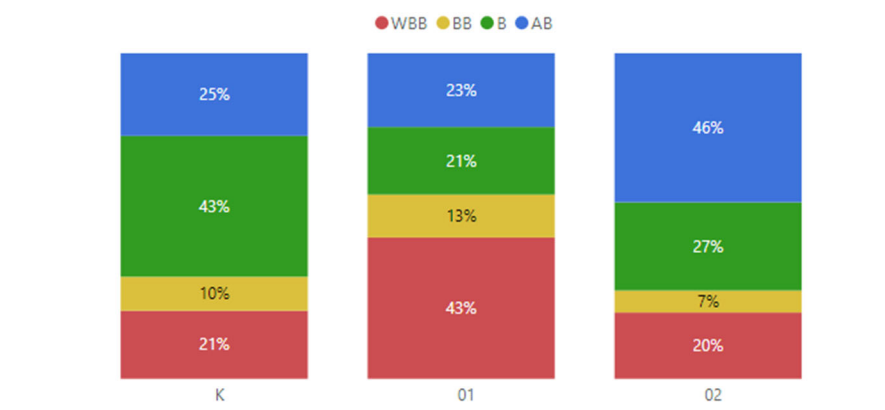
3. What are the metrics the LEA and school site are using to measure progress on growth (student data) and/or actions (implementation)?

- CKLA
- Section Assessments
- Skill Specific Assessments (e.g. fluency)
- Progress Monitoring

Include Year 3 quantitative results for kindergarten through grade three. In the table below, record the local literacy assessment used and the percentage of students scoring in the proficient (at or above standard) range in each of these grade levels.

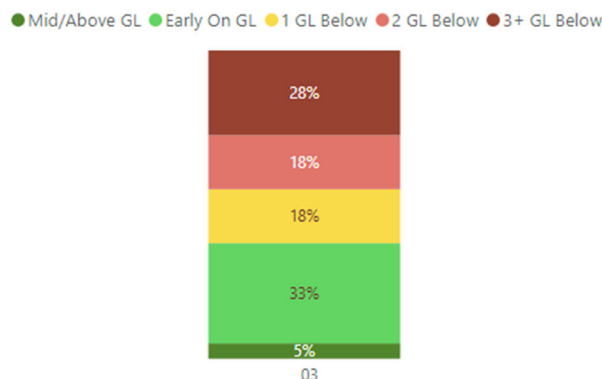
Grade Level	Local Literacy Assessment	Current % of Students At or Above Standard
Kindergarten	EOY DIBELS	68%
First Grade	EOY DIBELS	44%
Second Grade	EOY DIBELS	73%
Third Grade	EOY i-Ready	38%

ELA DIBELS Composite Level (Gr K-2)



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ELA Overall Relative Grade Level Placement



*Source: Interim Assessment Dashboard, June 10, 2024

4. Please provide an analysis of the metrics and specifically if the metrics are demonstrating progress towards goals. Compare baseline student data to current student data.

BOY/EOY Data Comparison

- K students in Benchmark and Above increased from 25% at BOY to 68% at EOY
- 1st grade students in Benchmark and Above increased from 26% BOY 44% EOY
- 2nd grade students in Benchmark and Above increased from 52% BOY to 73% EOY
- 3rd grade students in Benchmark and Above increased from 17% at BOY to 38% EOY

5. What has been the most notable change as a result of the site's ELSB grant work?

Teachers have become more aware of explicit, systematic early literacy instruction. Basic phonemic awareness and phonics are improving.

6. In what ways will the site continue to support and sustain the work begun through the ELSB grant program?

- We will continue to use Core Knowledge Language Arts (CKLA) which has shown to be effective at increasing early foundational language skills.
- District instructional supports through continued professional development
- Coaching Language Essentials for Teachers of Reading & Spelling (LETTRS)
 - 15 out of 18 teachers have taken the initiative to participate in ongoing LETTRS training
 - LETTRS will continue to be accessible to all teachers with on-site support
- Tier 2 and 3 intervention systems in place
- K-3 students will continue to receive additional support through Literacy Academies and push-in/pull-out interventions.

Eligible Participating School #5: West Athens Elementary

1. What are the "big picture" goals stated in the Literacy Action Plan? These can be located in Section 2: Literacy Action Plan Components.

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- Goal 1: Provide Teacher training in assessing and progress monitoring students
- Goal 2: Provide explicit phonemic awareness and phonics instruction

2. What are the actions the LEA and school site have taken to progress toward those goals in Year 3 of the grant?

West Athens has done the following towards meeting its goal of improving literacy instruction in TK/K-3:

- Hired interventionist teachers and aide to work with grades K-2 struggling students scoring Well Below Benchmark on DIBELS at the beginning of the school year.
- Offered and trained K-3 teachers with LETRS (Language Essentials for Teachers of Reading and Spelling) science of reading professional learning.
- Provided professional development to K-3 teachers on school/grade level achievement data and on the analysis of DIBELS benchmark assessments to use data inform small group development and instruction for students.
- Provided teacher training on administration and analysis of foundational skills assessments (CORE and DIBELS)
- Held regular Professional Learning Community meetings to engage in the Plan-Do-Study-Act cycle and provide professional learning data analysis of progress monitoring data to identify specific literacy skills for small group instruction, plan targeted instruction, and reflect on students' response to instruction in order to refine teacher work.
- Provided grade level teachers with professional development on research-based systematic foundational skills instruction to build coherence and consistency across the grade level.
- Shared school wide literacy achievement data as a whole and segregated by grade level, English Learner, and African American student achievement to see our student's achievement status and discuss next steps.
- Work with the parent organization Parent Institute for Quality Education to provide parents with information on how to support and build their children's literacy skills at home.

3. What are the metrics the LEA and school site are using to measure progress on growth (student data) and/or actions (implementation)?

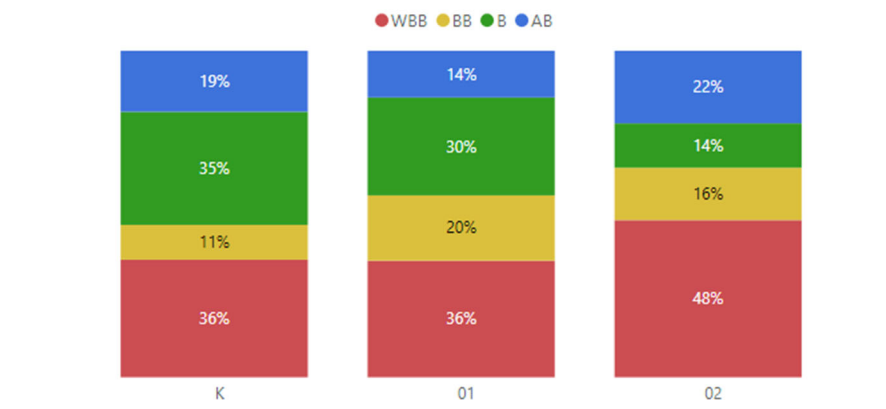
West Athens is using DIBELS and i-Ready assessment data to measure student progress in literacy achievement. Leadership walk-throughs to see implementation of literacy instruction.

Include Year 3 quantitative results for kindergarten through grade three. In the table below, record the local literacy assessment used and the percentage of students scoring in the proficient (at or above standard) range in each of these grade levels.

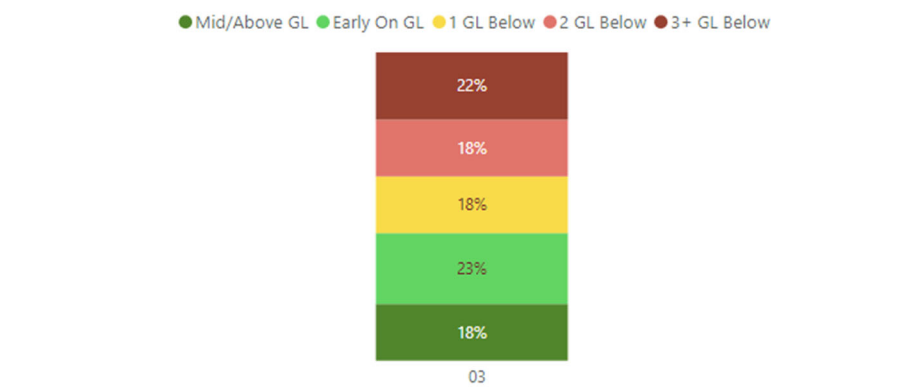
Grade Level	Local Literacy Assessment	Current % of Students At or Above Standard
Kindergarten	EOY DIBELS	54%
First Grade	EOY DIBELS	44%
Second Grade	EOY DIBELS	36%
Third Grade	EOY i-Ready	41%

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ELA DIBELS Composite Level (Gr K-2)



ELA Overall Relative Grade Level Placement



*Source: Interim Assessment Dashboard, June 10, 2024

4. Please provide an analysis of the metrics and specifically if the metrics are demonstrating progress towards goals. Compare baseline student data to current student data.

BOY/EOY Data Comparison

- K students in Benchmark and Above increased from 29% at BOY to 54% at EOY
- 1st grade students in Benchmark and Above increased from 21% BOY 44% EOY
- 2nd grade students in Benchmark and Above remained at 36% BOY to 36% EOY
- 3rd grade students in Benchmark and Above increased from 23% at BOY to 41% EOY

5. What has been the most notable change as a result of the site's ELSB grant work?

Despite continuous leadership turnover (5 Principals in 4 years), teacher turnover (5 teachers new to grades K-3 along with 2 long term subs in grade 1 this year alone), and reading interventionists turnover, a notable change that has occurred is a unified and consistent approach to instruction of foundational skills in core daily instruction and in small group lessons. Another shift has also begun with teachers beginning to understand their data tools, use of progress monitoring assessment, data analysis, and reflection on teacher practices and student learning. Teachers are engaging in the district's Plan-Do-Study-Act (PDSA) cycle of instruction through bimonthly Professional Learning Community meetings.

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West Athens teachers are also implementing small group instruction with connected independent literacy activities to reinforce students' learning of core and individualized instructional goals.

Finally, 15/19 TK-3 West Athens teachers engaged in LETRS professional development. Through the support of PLCS and PD, teachers are making connections from their learning to their curriculum and instructional planning.

6. In what ways will the site continue to support and sustain the work begun through the ELSB grant program?

West Athens is in the process of hiring a principal who will close out this school year and take West Athens into the new school year. Los Angeles Unified will support the principal as s/he transitions into the position to help the principal continue with systems that are in place and working as well as to continue to help build upon the successes and further the work of increasing student achievement.

West Athens will continue to support teachers in developing a habit of mind around data informed literacy instruction through PDSA cycles and grade level meetings/professional development.

West Athens will continue to support teachers' implementation of the district's core literacy curriculum and small group instruction making connections to the teacher learning on the science of reading.

West Athens will continue to provide targeted small group instruction focused on foundational literacy skills informed by data in all K-3 classrooms and will have a literacy interventionist to provide additional support to the students demonstrating the most need.

Eligible Participating School #6: YES Academy

1. What are the "big picture" goals stated in the Literacy Action Plan? These can be located in Section 2: Literacy Action Plan Components.

Goal 1: Explicit Foundational Skills Instruction

Goal 2: Literacy Small Group Instruction

Goal 3: Capacity Building/Reading Instruction

Goal 4: Family Support and Engagement

2. What are the actions the LEA and school site have taken to progress toward those goals in Year 3 of the grant?

The actions that have been undertaken are dedicated PM, regular data chats, the implementation of budget by purchasing items per plan, securing E.A.III to support K-2 staff, PDs on SOR, collaboration, efforts reviewed, revisited, and re-aligned as needed based on data, outreach to parents and community partners.

3. What are the metrics the LEA and school site are using to measure progress on growth (student data) and/or actions (implementation)?

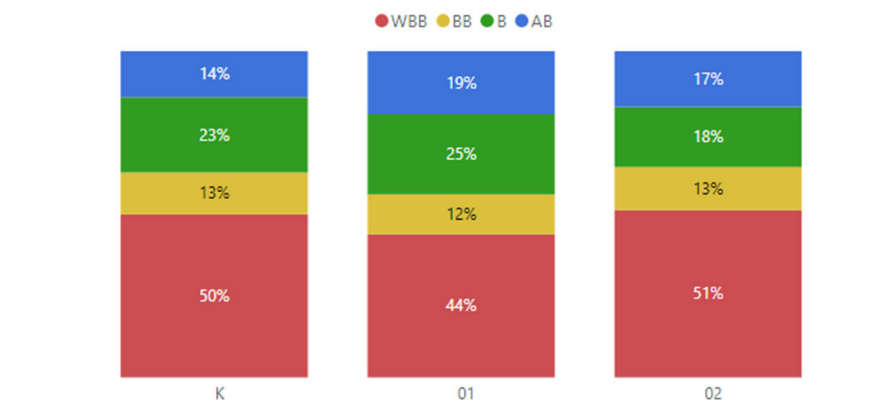
The following metrics guided our work towards literacy achievement: DIBELS, CORE Phonics Survey, Phonological Awareness Screening Test (PAST) assessments, i-Ready, SBA, Progress Monitoring, and attendance data. These data points provided needed information to determine next steps and informed decision-making.

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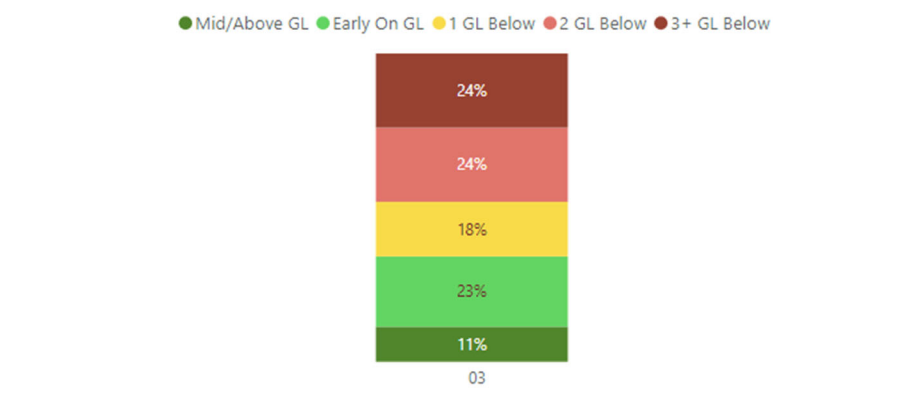
4. Include Year 3 quantitative results for kindergarten through grade three. In the table below, record the local literacy assessment used and the percentage of students scoring in the proficient (at or above standard) range in each of these grade levels.

Grade Level	Local Literacy Assessment	Current % of Students At or Above Standard
Kindergarten	EOY DIBELS	37%
First Grade	EOY DIBELS	44%
Second Grade	EOY DIBELS	35%
Third Grade	EOY i-Ready	34%

ELA DIBELS Composite Level (Gr K-2)



ELA Overall Relative Grade Level Placement



*Source: Interim Assessment Dashboard, June 10, 2024

- Please provide an analysis of the metrics and specifically if the metrics are demonstrating progress towards goals. Compare baseline student data to current student data.

BOY/EOY Data Comparison

- K students in Benchmark and Above increased from 32% at BOY to 37% at EOY
- 1st grade students in Benchmark and Above increased from 24% BOY 44% EOY

Submitted: 06/11/24, Revision #1

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- 2nd grade students in Benchmark and Above increased from 33% BOY to 35% EOY
- 3rd grade students in Benchmark and Above increased from 10% at BOY to 34% EOY

2. What has been the most notable change as a result of the site's ELSB grant work?

The most notable change as a result of the site's ELSB grant work has been a shift in teacher awareness surrounding the Science of Reading. Thus far, our focus has been to deepen our knowledge in systematic foundational skills through ongoing evidence based professional developments.

Noted Shifts:

- Teachers' mindset regarding the Science of Reading and implementing instruction
- Literacy gains-students' conceptualization
- Teachers' capacity and knowledge surrounding P.A. instruction and implementation
- Awareness of Data and the need to shift
- Foundational skills focus
- Teachers' collective efficacy

3. In what ways will the site continue to support and sustain the work begun through the ELSB grant program?

Our focus will be to continue to improve our reading fluency and comprehension metrics through systematic instruction in phonics, phonemic awareness, and word recognition through small group instruction associated with the Science of Reading via focused, targeted, structured literacy informed by DATA. Our work will be supported by the various resources, training, and support that have been put in place as a result of having access to the ELSBG funding.

We will support the sustainability of our efforts to maintain momentum by budgeting funds, conducting book studies and study groups to concretize learning gains, monitor classroom instruction and data to stay informed, promote and encourage participation in District provided learning opportunities associated with the Science of Reading.

We will continue to improve in our knowledge and skill in implementing an explicit systematic foundational skills program with fidelity across TK/K-3 classrooms as measured by our professional development calendar and DIBELS assessment, CORE Phonics Survey, and Phonological Awareness Screening Test (PAST) assessment.

We will implement strategies gained from professional development-Language Essentials for Teachers of Reading and Spelling (LETRS) which provided information and resources in literacy instruction including explicit foundational skills instruction, small group instruction, and the use of data.

We will carry on with improving our TK/K-3 students' reading fluency by providing systematic instruction in phonics, phonemic awareness, word recognition, and providing students opportunities to practice skills during targeted small group instruction with progress monitoring and analyzing data as measured by DIBELS, CORE Phonics Survey, and Phonological Awareness Screening Test (PAST) assessment.

We will continue to have weekly grade level meetings, Professional Development focusing on literacy and teacher choice professional developments.

We will continue to strive to improve our TK/K-3rd grade students' reading fluency by providing our families with instructional material, workshops, and literacy night events (activities) in phonics, word

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recognition, phonemic awareness, decodable readers and opportunities for parents to practice these skills at home as measured by DIBELS, CORE Phonics Survey, and Phonological Awareness Screening Test (PAST) assessments and event sign-ins.

We will continue to provide parents and families opportunities to participate in Family Literacy Night, parent literacy workshops, and provide parents with resources to support students and provide them with opportunities to practice literacy skills at home.

In order to nurture the idea of teaching with fidelity to ensure literacy gains for all students, the goal of allowing teachers to continue to receive professional development based on explicit instruction and data analyzation will be at the forefront of our mission.